

1. The memory shortage is causing a repricing of consumer electronics

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-22T22:01:31+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/22/memory-shortage/#atom-everything>

The memory shortage is causing a repricing of consumer electronics David Oks provides the clearest explanation I've seen yet of why consumer products that use memory are likely to get significantly more expensive over the next few years. The short version is that memory manufacturers - of which there are just three remaining large companies - have a fixed capacity in terms of how many wafers they can process at any one time. This fixed wafer capacity is then split between DDR - used in desktops and servers, LPDDR - used in mobile phones and low-energy devices, and HBM - used with GPUs. Until recently, HBM got just 2% of that wafer allocation. The enormous growth in AI data centers has pushed that up to an expected 20% by the end of 2026, and "a single gigabyte of HBM consumes more than three times the wafer capacity that a gigabyte of DDR or LPDDR does". Memory companies have learned from the extinction of their rivals that you should always under-provision rather than over-provision your fabricator capacity. The profit margins and demand for HBM (high-bandwidth memory) will constrain the production of consumer-device RAM for several years. This is already being felt in the sub-\$1...

2. FTC to Require Cox Media Group, Two Other Firms to Pay Nearly \$1 Million to Settle

Charges They Deceived Customers About ?Active Listening? AI-Powered Marketing Service

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-22T04:48:32+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/22/ftc-active-listening/#atom-everything>

FTC to Require Cox Media Group, Two Other Firms to Pay Nearly \$1 Million to Settle Charges They Deceived Customers About ?Active Listening? AI-Powered Marketing Service Back in 2024 Cox Media Group were caught trying to sell advertisers packages based on "active listening", with this deck which claimed: Smart devices capture real-time intent data by listening to our conversations Advertisers can pair this voice-data with behavioral data to target in-market consumers I wrote about this in September 2024 . My theory: I think active listening is the term that the team came up with for ?something that sounds fancy but really just means the way ad targeting platforms work already?. Then they got over-excited about the new metaphor and added that first couple of slides that talk about ?voice data?, without really understanding how the tech works or what kind of a shitstorm that could kick off when people who DID understand technology started paying attention to their marketing. This FTC press release appears to confirm that's pretty much what happened: CMG, MindSift and 1010 Digital Works claimed their ?Active Listening? branded marketing service listened in on consumers? conversations...

3. datasette-agent 0.1a3

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-21T15:04:09+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/21/datasette-agent-2/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-agent 0.1a3 "View SQL query" buttons for both visible tables and collapsed SQL result tool calls. Don't display empty reasoning chunks Improved handling of truncated responses - table still displays to the user even if the SQL results were truncated when showing the agent. See Datasette Agent, an extensible AI assistant for Datasette . Tags: datasette , datasette-agent

4. News about Raspberry Pi 6 and Microcontroller Development

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Fri, 22 May 2026 15:15:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/news-about-raspberry-pi-6-and-microcontroller-development/>

On Thursday, three of the lead Raspberry Pi engineers hosted an AMA on the r/engineering subreddit . Raspberry Pi 6 One of the most interesting tidbits was on the Pi 6. Looking back at

previous launches: 2012: Raspberry Pi 2015: Raspberry Pi 2 (+3 years) 2016: Raspberry Pi 3 (+1 year) 2019: Raspberry Pi 4 (+3 years) 2023: Raspberry Pi 5 (+4 years) Following that cycle, one would expect a Pi 6 3-4 years after the Pi 5, which would put it in 2026 or 2027.

5. ? The Fonts of the U.S. Federal Courts

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-22T20:30:18Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/05/the_fonts_of_the_us_federal_courts

The Supreme Court's typographic style has been stunningly consistent for ? no pun intended ? well over a century.

6. The Ninth Circuit Appeal Ruling in ?Epic v. Apple? That Apple Is Seeking to Overturn at the Supreme Court (PDF)

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-22T17:39:05Z

Link: <https://cdn.ca9.uscourts.gov/datastore/opinions/2025/12/11/25-2935.pdf>

Following up on yesterday's item re: Apple's petition to the Supreme Court, here's the Ninth Circuit ruling. It starts with a ?Summary? that is specifically intended for the convenience of the reader. Page 50 is where it covers Apple's argument regarding Trump v. CASA as precedent that an injunction on commissions should apply only to Epic Games, not to all developers in the U.S. App Store. ?

7. Zero Sum Problems and Apple Sports

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-22T17:15:00Z

Link: <https://kieranhealy.org/blog/archives/2026/05/21/zero-sum-problems/>

Kieran Healy kindly accepted my implicit homework assignment yesterday , and wrote a piece on Apple Sports's bizarre ?zero sum? team stats visualization: It also doesn't do away with the core problem. That problem is principally one of information design rather than data visualization. What I mean is that what we're trying to organize is, in effect, fifteen pairs of related but fundamentally distinct numbers. If we had fifteen cases and two variables things would be simple. But with fifteen variables and two cases ? well, this is not the kind of thing you can make a single effective and non-confusing graph out of. That's why I kind of sympathize with the designer. In a constrained space they have to show thirty numbers (thirty two, including the score). Lots of information. A straight table seems like it would be boring. Surely there's some way to thematically integrate the numbers in a visually appealing manner that brings out some of the relationships across the rows. That's what graphs do; it seems like the right thing to reach for. But at its heart this information is not a graph. It just sort of looks like one, and that ends up confusing people. Just a crackerjack explanation...

8. Why do you say that a COM STA thread must pump messages if I see sample code creating STA threads and not pumping messages?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 22 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260522-00/?p=112348>

You need to pump messages when idle, but maybe you are never idle. The post Why do you say that a COM STA thread must pump messages if I see sample code creating STA threads and not pumping messages? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. How do I use Win32 structures from the Windows Runtime?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 21 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260521-00/?p=112345>

Trick question: You can't. But maybe you can fake it. The post How do I use Win32 structures from the Windows Runtime? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. Lawmakers Demand Answers as CISA Tries to Contain Data Leak

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Fri, 22 May 2026 16:34:24 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/05/lawmakers-demand-answers-as-cisa-tries-to-contain-data-leak/>

Lawmakers in both houses of Congress are demanding answers from the U.S. Cybersecurity & Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) after KrebsOnSecurity reported this week that a CISA contractor intentionally published AWS GovCloud keys and a vast trove of other agency secrets on a public GitHub account. The inquiry comes as CISA is still struggling to contain the breach and invalidate the leaked credentials.

11. The commencement speech that shook the world

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Sat, 23 May 2026 01:14:24 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/the-commencement-speech-that-shook-the-world?src=feed>

There he was, the man at the helm of innovation. Eric Schmidt, the former CEO of Google. The man who once said, google doesn't need to record your conversation, it already knows everything about you. Yet he didn't see this one coming. In his speech, he looked clear-eyed into the crowd of graduates and told them that AI is inevitable. There was a group of people who will have a hard time joining the workforce. Companies keep using AI as the excuse for laying off workers. Dario keeps telling us by next year, AI will take over all jobs and there is nothing we can do. They will have nothing, and they better embrace it and be happy. Well, they will have a school loan, but that's it. If you were an external observer, maybe an alien watching humanity from a distance, you would think that AI is a new species that emerged from a lake and is taking over the world. You would never tell that the people spreading this fear are also the ones selling the tool that they swear will turn us all into gods. It's not just a capable tool that can be useful for coding, writing, and retrieving existing information. No. It's the word itself. The all or nothing. The alpha and the omega. And it comes as a m...

12. How to Talk to Your Coworkers

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Fri, 22 May 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/how-to-talk-to-your-coworkers?src=feed>

You know you explained the same issue before in two or three different places, yet here they are asking again. Why don't they understand you? Why do they ask the same question when you've already given them the answer right there on Jira? Are they stupid? Lazy, maybe? Do they not take the time to read? I often hear this from developers. They write clear documentation and instructions, and people still bother them to hop on a call. This happens so frequently that I think it is worth addressing. An over-abundance of information is just as confusing as too little. But something I should add is that repetition is normal. In fact, repetition should be a tool you use frequently. To do our jobs as developers, we read instructions. Our tasks are usually carefully written and specced out as a document we can implement and check off. There are usually bullet points, requirements, and acceptance criteria. Sometimes, you could implement a feature by following the instructions without even knowing or understanding what the feature actually does. In other jobs, non-technical ones, people derive their work from conversation. A lossy format. For example, when a non-technical manager wants a new f...

13. Dependency Pruning

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-22T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/22/dependency-pruning.html>

The best time to prune your dependency tree was three years ago. The second best time is right now. Every package in your lockfile is a door someone else holds the key to. Install scripts run on your CI with whatever credentials your CI has, the maintainer's account can be phished or the registry entry handed to a new owner, and the next patch release can be something quite different from the last one. A dependency you stopped calling two refactors ago is exposed to all of that exactly as much as one you hit on every request, and you still get paged when a CVE lands in it. The cheapest supply-chain hardening you can do is to stop supplying yourself with things you don't use. Lately my first response to a Dependabot CVE alert, and a fair few of the routine version bumps, has been to check whether I still need the dependency at all before looking at what changed in it. A CVE in something I barely use is a better reason to delete it than to patch it, and ripping it out closes that alert and all the future ones at the same time. You don't need any tooling for that beyond the alert itself. Most of the existing writing

about trimming dependencies is aimed at frontend bundle size, tree-s...

14. Premium: What If...We're In An AI Bubble? (Part 2)

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 22 May 2026 16:21:32 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-what-if-were-in-an-ai-bubble-part-2/>

Last week I ran the first part of my What If?We're In An AI Bubble? Series, where I asked questions and posed scenarios as to the consequences of the many, many questions I've asked over the last few years. It quickly became one of

15. News: OpenAI Had A Negative 122% Non-GAAP Operating Margin In Q1 2026, and ChatGPT Growth Has Stalled

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 22 May 2026 14:21:18 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/news-openai-had-a-negative-122-operating-margin-in-q1-2026-and-chatgpt-growth-has-stalled/>

Executive Summary: The Information reports that OpenAI generated \$5.7bn in revenue for the first quarter of 2026 based on discussions with sources familiar with its financials. With adjusted negative margins of -122%, this means that for every dollar of revenue OpenAI made, it lost an additional \$1.22, or

16. StubZero: \$148,337 RCE in Google Cloud Production

Source: Brutecat • Research | Published: Mon, 01 Jun 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://brutecat.com/articles/google-cloud-rce>

A chance Discord message, two missing pieces, and one hour before the window closed: From info leak to RCE on Google Cloud. Three months later, it happened again.

17. Reiner Pope ? Chip design from the bottom up

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Fri, 22 May 2026 15:38:34 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/reiner-pope-2>

Working up from basic logic gates to why GPUs, TPUs, FPGAs, and the human brain each look the way they do.

18. Planescape: Torment, Part 1: From the Tabletop?

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 22 May 2026 16:27:41 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/05/planescape-torment-part-1-from-the-tabletop/>

This article tells part of the general story of Dungeons & Dragons on the tabletop and on computers, which includes the more specific one of the Infinity Engine games. My power fantasy when playing a role-playing game is to confront a villain, explain point by point why his master plan is flawed, and then get [?]

19. Why no breakthrough yet? Or, why is it 'taking so long' to test COVID-19 treatments?

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 04 Apr 2020 13:27:10 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/corona-trial-math/>

Many many possible medicines are being touted as possibly being helpful in fighting COVID-19.

Here's a small list where we have some initial results or at least anecdotes:

(hydroxy)chloroquine, with azithromycin or zinc: This is the ?tech-bro? favorite right now, partially based on recommendations from Elon Musk and Donald Trump, two noted medical professionals. There have been a few reports on this working or not working. This article argues that an alternation of negative and positive results actually is to be expected, even if the treatment is fairly effective, which it might be.

20. Our amazing immune system

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Wed, 01 Apr 2020 22:27:10 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/immune-system/>

(On this page in Dutch I post daily bits of realistic but hopeful Corona news. Here is a somewhat rough translation of an article on our immune system I posted there, because I think it

might also be useful for people that don't speak Dutch). Wednesday, April 1st COVID-19 can only live thanks to us. Viruses cannot reproduce independently, they need our help. And our immune system makes this very hard, as aptly explained in this excellent xkcd comic:

21. Corona Science Journal

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 30 Mar 2020 11:09:45 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/corona-science/>

Hello and welcome to this stream of consciousness I dare to call "the Corona Science Journal".

Latest update: 30th of March 11:34 UTC. View history of this page [on

GitHub](<https://github.com/ahupowerdns/corona-science/commits/master>)

([RSS](<https://github.com/ahupowerdns/corona-science/commits/master/corona-science.md.atom>)),

where you can also submit changes, fixes and updates. Note: I have been unable to keep up with the latest developments as I have shifted my efforts to a Dutch-language daily blog about positive COVID-19 developments, while keeping it real.